

Mukhopadhyay, “Honestly, the world has become smaller. Video calling and WhatsApp specifically has improved relationships. The feeling of togetherness even when you’re not together is what tech has done.”

It’s all about where you draw the line. There is a reason that things like WhatsApp’s blue ticks are made fun of when it comes to couples – because behind that humor, they actually do affect a relationship. With people having the ability to constantly keep track and stay in touch with their partner, personal space in a relationship has reduced over time in many cases. “One of the things about tech is the obligations”, says Sharanya, “Your last seen was two minutes ago and you didn’t reply yet? The desire to communicate has been replaced by the obligation to communicate”.

Is this healthy? In no possible way. A constantly connected relationship leaves no time or space for an individual to realise their own potential or simply pursue their interests. “When it comes to serious relationships,” says Divya, “sometimes it reaches an unhealthy level in the form of cyberstalking. Somewhere, the constant pinging and trying to reach does cut you off from your other activities. In fact, this is no different than the unhealthy way in which technology has connected you to work.”

Paradoxically, the same tech that creates this concern also makes us more lazy and forgetful. We don’t need to take the effort to remember anniversaries thanks to reminders and calendars, but we still have



Connectivity can lead to unhealthy levels of obsession

to order our own gifts. Ordering something off Amazon on same-day delivery might do the trick but it just isn’t the same as making a handmade card over weeks, or is it? Many would say that tech is the reason behind the fast pace of today’s world, and in this very world, if tech is the enabler that helps you deal with that pace – it is more an evolution of society than a side effect. And if you blame tech for the high standards the internet sets for your romance – don’t forget it the next time you upload a picture with your SO on Instagram and it gets hundreds of likes.

## THE FIDELITY QUESTION

It is one thing to leave one person for another. But today, a large population has come to prefer straddling the line in between the two (no pun intended). Cheating on a partner today, with the help of technology, is too easy. Taking the fake personality that you create for a social network, you can go ahead and create an entirely new identity if needed. The thrill of anonymity is a strong pull for many acts of infidelity that wouldn’t exist beyond the mind otherwise.

In fact, cases of people being duped for money or sexual harassment by fake profiles on social networks have been in the news for quite a while now. “I have been taking to this client who I counsel”, says Joshua C.D, a Bangalore based writer and wildlife photographer, “She met a guy online trusted him and then sent him ‘nudes’ and money in the name of love through online (platforms). All he did was take and sell it on online porn sites and block her from reaching him. She had no sign of contacting or reporting him because in the world of the internet you can disappear more quickly than you appear”.

Even if you’re not going to the extent of creating a fake profile, you aren’t really out of the scope of cheating. Take Facebook’s privacy settings, for example, that let you manage who sees what at various levels of acquaintance – so one person could have a completely different view of your online life than another. Rather convenient, isn’t it?

Is technology influencing the tendency to cheat? A survey conducted by MyLife.com in 2013 had revealed that about 56% of social media users suffered from the fear of missing out (fomo). The constant fomo that we face, due to the state of technology right now that demands constant connectivity, does flow over to our relationships as well. We never really commit entirely for the fear of missing out on a perfect someone outside the existing relation.

## BREAKING LOVE

Sex is an important aspect of any adult romantic relationship, and it’s changed drastically as well. The boxes littered across the cover story will have given you a somewhat kinky insight into

### MAX & NORA

Again a hit product from the makers of Lush, these little bundles of joy are designed to be companion devices. While the Lush was more of a solo adventure, Max & Nora are devices designed for long distance passion. So the idea is when you move your toy one way, the companion device moves the other even if it’s miles apart – perfect for long distance couples who are trying to keep the fires burning. The entangled devices will even mimic speeds. The company says their video chat is encrypted and goes directly between the devices without passing through their servers. But if you don’t trust them, Skype is also supported. A very similar competing set of gadgets by the name of KIROO Onyx and Pearl are also available; you know, for those looking for variety.



Now that’s the kind of intrusive ping we wouldn’t mind receiving